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Rules Contributing to certutil.exe Certificate Extraction Alert 6.3.0

The following rules are used to identify certutil.exe certificate extraction activity. Any one or more of these will trigger the certutil.exe Certificate Extraction Alert. Details for each rule can be viewed by clicking the **More Details** link in the description.

Title	Description
certutil.exe Certificate Extraction	The following analytic identifies the use of certutil.exe with arguments indicating the manipulation or extraction of certificates. This activity is significant because extracting certificates can allow attackers to sign new authentication tokens, particularly in federated environments like Windows ADFS. If confirmed malicious, this could enable attackers to forge authentication tokens, potentially leading to unauthorized access and privilege escalation within the network.

More details

Rule ID

```
certutil_exe_certificate_extraction
```

Query

```
{'selection1': {'Image|endswith': '\\certutil.exe'}, 'selection2':
{'CommandLine|contains': '-
exportPFX'}, 'condition': 'selection1 and selection2'}
```

Log Source

Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:

- Monitoring process creation

Rule Source

Developed internally by Stellar Cyber

Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

TA0006, T1649

References

- https://blog.sygnia.co/detection-and-hunting-of-golden-saml-attack
- https://strontic.github.io/xcyclopedia/library/certutil.exe-09A8A29BAA3A451713FD3D07943B4A43.html

Severity

Title	Description
90 	

Suppression Logic Based On

- computer_name
- process_name
- event_data.CommandLine
- stellar.rule_id

Additional Information

Maturity	Creation Date	Risk Level	False Positives
experimental	2025/08/18	critical	• Unless there are specific use cases, manipulating or exporting certificates using certutil is uncommon. Extraction of certificate has been observed during attacks such as Golden SAML and other campaigns targeting Federated services.

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